c. The narrator visited the sale-room as he _____.

i. wished to see an auction
ii. had a painting to sell
iii. was persuaded by his friend
iv. wanted to buy a painting

d. The narrator had been a safe contributor at the auction, as _____.

i. there were bidders quoting higher prices
ii. he had a sound financial background
iii. his friend had lent him money
iv. he did not make any bidding

e. "And I got it." Here 'it' refers to the_____.

i. picture he wanted to buy
ii. money he asked for
iii. card to participate in the auction
iv. amount he had to pay

2. Answer the following questions.

a) What is a tight corner? What happens when one finds oneself in a tight corner?

b) What is the difference between a physical and mental tight corner?

c) Why did the narrator visit Christie's?

d) The narrator heard his own voice saying, 'and fifty'. What does this suggest?

e) What was the narrator's financial condition?

f) The narrator could not pretend to have made a mistake in bidding. Why?

g) What could have been the best way for the narrator, to get himself out of the tight corner?

h) Why did the narrator feel he could have welcomed a firing party?

i) What was the bidder's offer to the narrator?

j) How did the narrator take advantage of the situation?

3. Form a meaningful summary of the lesson by rewriting the numbers in the correct sequence:

a) The narrator had only 63 pounds with him and did not know how to manage the situation. ( )

b) The narrator thought of all his relations from whom he could borrow. ( )

c) Unfortunately he had made the highest bid. ( )

d) The narrator entered Christie's as his friend persuaded him to visit the sale-room. ( )

e) Every time someone else made a higher bid and the narrator was not caught. ( )

f) The narrator on a sudden impulse added 50 more guineas, to the amount offered. ( )

g) His friend joined him then but left immediately unable to control his laughter. ( )

h) He even thought of borrowing from moneylenders and considered the possibility of confessing the truth to the staff at Christie's. ( )

i) The picture was declared sold to the narrator. ( )

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